especially Greek mythology, which he would pore over for hours at a time.

Edward's father, Lon, served as a warrant officer in the US Coast Guard, and his mother, Wendy, was chief deputy clerk in the Baltimore US District Court. They divorced in 2001. Edward's older sister, Jessica, became a lawyer at the Federal Judicial Center in Washington, DC. Like his family, Edward expected to work in the federal government.

Though he was smart—his father reported two IQ tests put Edward's IQ above 145—Edward did not finish high school. A case of mononucleosis kept him out of Arundel High School for nine months. Not wanting to repeat the tenth grade, he completed his general equivalency diploma (GED) and studied computing at Anne Arundel Community College beginning in 1999. He never earned a degree, instead hanging out with friends who shared his passion for computers, video games, and Japanese anime.

Patriotic Fervor

Snowden had been in love with computers since he was a kid, and he began working for a community college classmate who ran a technology business. On his way to

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